

WOMEN AND CHILD WELFARE

Women empowerment in India is the most effective tool for development as these days; women across the world are actively working as a leader and surpassing others in all the spheres of life. As the entire world is clasp its breath and praying every single day for an incredible escape from the COVID-19 Pandemic, it is the women governors and nations steered by these amazing figures who are taking over the responsibility and marching ahead in the battle alone wherever required.

Definition: Empowerment

Empowerment means individuals acquiring the power to think and act freely, exercise choices and fulfil their potential as full and equal members of the society.

Women Empowerment: Goal and Objectives

- The goal of this Policy is to bring about the advancement, development, to encourage active participation and empowerment of women.

- **The objectives of this Policy:**

- ◆ Creating an environment through positive economic and social policies for the development of women

- .◆ In all human rights and fundamental freedom for women on equal basis with men in all: political, economic, social, cultural and civil.

- ◆ Equal access to participation and decision making of women in

Social, Political, Economic life of the nation,

Health care, Employment Quality education at all levels,

Equal remuneration, Occupational health and safety,

Social security and public office etc.

- ◆ Strengthening the legal systems aimed at elimination of all forms of discrimination against women

- .◆ Changing societal attitudes and community practices by active participation.

- ◆ Elimination of discrimination and all forms of violence against women and the girl child.

- ◆ Building and strengthening partnerships with civil society, particularly women's organizations.

Education is the initial line of defense for women. With a meaningful education, the women's status strides beyond the restrictions of motherliness. Advancement of education of women and girls allots to the postponement of their marriage timing and the ensuing constriction in the volume of their families.

NATIONAL POLICY FOR THE EMPOWERMENT OF WOMEN (2001)

Women Empowerment in India:

- **Very essential for the development of society.**

Empowerment of women has becoming a burning issue all over the world including India since last few decades.

- The **principle of gender equality** is enshrined in the Indian Constitution in its Preamble, Fundamental Rights, Fundamental Duties and Directive Principles.

The Constitution not only grants equality to women, but also empowers the State to adopt measures of positive discrimination in favour of women.

- From the **Fifth Five Year Plan** (1974-78) onwards has been a marked shift in the approach to women's issues from welfare to development.

In recent years, the empowerment of women has been recognized as the central issue in determining the status of women.

- The **National Commission for Women** was set up by an Act of Parliament in 1990 to safeguard the rights and legal entitlements of women.

The 73rd and 74th Amendments (1993) to the Constitution of India have provided for reservation of seats in the local bodies of Panchayats and Municipalities for women, laying a strong foundation for their participation in decision making at the local levels.

Women Empowerment Schemes:

Some schemes are:

- Rajiv Gandhi National Creche Scheme For the Children of Working Mothers
- Ministry approves new projects under Ujjawala Scheme and continues existing projects
- **UJJAWALA:** A Comprehensive Scheme for Prevention of trafficking and Rescue, Rehabilitation and Re-integration of Victims of Trafficking and Commercial Sexual Exploitation
- Working Women Hostel
- **SWADHAR** Greh (A Scheme for Women in Difficult Circumstances)
- Revision under IGMSY in Accordance with National Food Security Act, 2013 in XIIth Plan
- Support to Training and Employment Programme for Women (STEP)
- **NARI SHAKTI PURASKAR**
- Awardees of Stree Shakti Puruskar, 2014 & Awardees of Nari Shakti Puruskar
- Awardees of Rajya Mahila Samman & Zila Mahila Samman
- Indira Gandhi Matritva Sahyog Yojana (IGMSY) - A Conditional Maternity Benefit Scheme
- One Stop Centre Scheme
- Women Helpline Scheme

- **POSHAN Abhiyaan**

Malnutrition is not a direct cause of death but contributes to mortality and morbidity by reducing resistance to infections. There are a number of causes of death of children such as prematurity, low birth weight, pneumonia, diarrhoeal diseases, non-communicable diseases, birth asphyxia & birth trauma, injuries, congenital anomalies, acute bacterial sepsis and severe infections, etc.

POSHAN Abhiyaan (National Nutrition Mission) is a flagship programme of the Ministry of Women and Child Development (MWCD), Government of India, which ensures convergence

with various programmes i.e., Anganwadi Services, Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY), Scheme for Adolescent Girls (SAG) of MWCD Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY), National Health Mission (NHM), Swachh-Bharat Mission, Public Distribution System (PDS), Department Food & Public Distribution, Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGS) and Ministry of Drinking Water & Sanitation.

The National Nutrition Mission (NNM) has been set up with a three year budget of Rs.9046.17 crore commencing from 2017-18. The NNM is a comprehensive approach towards raising nutrition level in the country on a war footing.



Photo courtesy : <https://poshangyan.niti.gov.in/poshan-abhiyaan-logo>

Goals:

The goals of NNM are to achieve improvement in nutritional status of Children from 0-6 years, Adolescent Girls, Pregnant Women and Lactating Mothers in a time bound manner during the next three years beginning 2017-18.

BENEFITS:

More than 10 crore people will be benefitted by this programme. All the States and districts will be covered in a phased manner i.e. 315 districts in 2017-18, 235 districts in 2018-19 and remaining districts in 2019-20

- **BETI BACHAO BETI PADHAO YOJANA:**

Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP) was launched by the Prime Minister on 22nd January, 2015 at Panipat, Haryana. BBBP addresses the declining Child Sex Ratio (CSR) and related issues of women empowerment over a life-cycle continuum. It is a tri-ministerial effort of Ministries of Women and Child Development, Health & Family Welfare and Human Resource Development.

In 2015, the Indian government introduced the Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao (BBBP) scheme to address concerns of gender discrimination and women empowerment in the country. The name Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao translates to 'Save the girl child, educate the girl child'. The scheme aims to educate citizens against gender bias and improve efficacy of welfare services for girls. It was launched with an initial funding of Rs. 100 crore (US\$ 13.5 million).

GOAL:

The Beti Bachao Beti Padhao Yojana aims to achieve the following goals:

- Improve the child sex ratio
- Ensure gender equality and women empowerment
- Prevent gender-biased, sex selective elimination
- Ensure survival and protection of the girl child
- Encourage education and participation of the girl child

Beneficiaries

Categories	Description
Primary Segment	Young and newly married couples; pregnant and lactating mothers; and parents
Secondary Segment	Youth, adolescents (girls and boys), in-laws, medical doctors/practitioners, private hospitals, nursing homes and diagnostic centres
Tertiary Segment	Officials, PRIs, frontline workers, women SHGs/collectives, religious leaders, voluntary organisations, media, medical associations, industry associations and the people at large
	

Photo courtesy :<https://www.logopeople.in/blog/free-vector-logo-download-of-beti-bachao-beti-padhao-yojana/>

ANGANWADI:

Anganwadi is a government-sponsored child-care and mother-care development programmes in India at the village level. The meaning of the word ‘Anganwadi’ in the English language is “courtyard shelter”. It primarily caters to children in the 0-6 age group. They were started by the Indian government in 1975 as part of the Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) program to combat child hunger and malnutrition. An Anganwadi centre provides basic health care facilities in Indian villages. It is a part of the Indian public health-care system.

Objectives

- to improve the nutritional and health status of children in the age-group 0-6 years
- to lay the foundation for proper psychological, physical and social development of the child
- to reduce the incidence of mortality, morbidity, malnutrition and school dropout

- (iv) to achieve effective co-ordination of policy and implementation amongst the various departments to promote child development and
- (v) to enhance the capability of the mother to look after the normal health and nutritional needs of the child through proper nutrition and health education.

In order to achieve the Anganwadi Services objectives, a package of six services comprising'

- (i) Supplementary nutrition
- (ii) (ii) Pre-school non-formal education; (iii) nutrition & health education; (iv) immunization; (v) health check-up; and (vi) referral services are provided to the targeted beneficiaries i.e. all children below 6 years, Pregnant Women and Lactating Mothers. Three of the six services namely Immunisation, Health Check-up and Referral Services are delivered through Public Health Infrastructure under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

All the children in the age group 6 months to 6 years, Pregnant Women and Lactating Mothers are eligible for services under Anganwadi Services. Anganwadi Services is a self selecting scheme and no targets are fixed for the beneficiaries of either Supplementary Nutrition or Pre-school non-formal education. As on 31.03.2021, there are 675.07 lakh children and 156.73 lakh Pregnant and Lactating Mothers receiving Supplementary Nutrition at Anganwadi Centres.



Photo courtesy
recruitment.html

:<https://www.waytwojobs.com/2021/07/wcd-anganwadi-jobs-recruitment.html>

INTEGRATED CHILD PROTECTION SCHEME (ICPS)

- About ICPS

The Integrated Child Protection Scheme (ICPS) is a centrally sponsored scheme aimed at building a protective environment for children in difficult circumstances, as well as other vulnerable children, through Government-Civil Society Partnership.

- The ICPS : Objectives

ICPS brings together multiple existing child protection schemes of the Ministry under one comprehensive umbrella, and integrates additional interventions for protecting children and preventing harm. ICPS, therefore, would institutionalize essential services and strengthen structures, enhance capacities at all levels, create database and knowledge base for child

protection services, strengthen child protection at family and community level, ensure appropriate inter-sectoral response at all levels.

The scheme would set up a child protection data management system to formulate and implement effective intervention strategies and monitor their outcomes. Regular evaluation of the programmes and structures would be conducted and course correction would be undertaken.

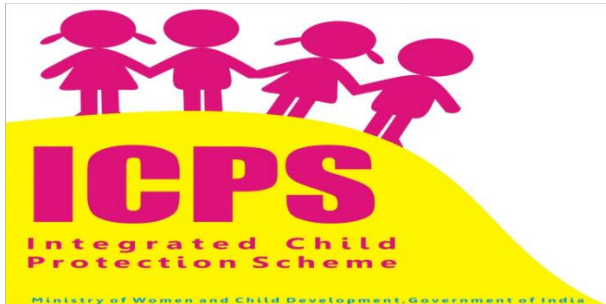


Photo courtesy :<https://journalsofindia.com/the-integrated-child-protection-schemeicps/>

NATIONAL CRECHE SCHEME FOR THE CHILDREN OF WORKING MOTHERS

A crèche is a facility which enables parents to leave their children while they are at work and where children are provided stimulating environment for their holistic development. Crèches are designed to provide group care to children, usually up to 6 years of age, who need care, guidance and supervision away from their home during the day.

OBJECTIVES

- (i) To provide day-care facilities for children (6 months to 6 years) of working mothers in the community.
- (ii) To improve nutrition and health status of children.
- (iii) To promote physical, cognitive, social and emotional development (Holistic Development) of children.
- (iv) To educate and empower parents /caregivers for better childcare.

SERVICES The scheme will provide an integrated package of the following services:

- (i) Day-care Facilities including Sleeping Facilities.
- (ii) Early Stimulation for children below 3 years and Pre-school Education for 3 to 6 years old children.
- (iii) Supplementary Nutrition(to be locally sourced)
- (iv) Growth Monitoring.
- (v) Health Check-up and Immunization.

S.No.	Age group of children	Number of children to be enrolled	Number of Crèche Worker	Number of Crèche Helper
1	6 months to 3 years.	10 (preferably)	01	01
2	3+ to 6 years	15		
	Total	25	01	01



Photo courtesy: <https://www.adda247.com/upsc-exam/national-creche-scheme/>

- **MAHILA SHAKTI KENDRA SCHEME**

1. Government of India has approved a new scheme namely, Mahila Shakti Kendra for implementation during 2017-18 upto 2019-20 to empower rural women through community participation and to create an environment in which they realize their full potential. It will provide an interface for rural women to approach the government for availing their entitlements also empowering them through training and capacity building.

Components of MSK scheme:

National level : Domain based experts provide support in implementation of all women centric schemes/programmes of the Government with the aim to strengthen the conceptual and programmatic basis of such schemes through convergence with Ministries and State Government /UT Adm.

State level : At the state level, the State Resource Centre for Women (SRCW) under the State Governments (Department of WCD/Social Welfare) provide technical assistance towards implementing programmes, laws and schemes meant for women through effective coordination at the State/UT level.

District level : District Level Centre for Women (DLCW) collate information on government programmes, schemes and services meant for women empowerment (including Beti Bachao Beti Pado (BBBP), One Stop Centre, Women Helpline, Mahila Police Volunteers, Swadhar, Ujja wala, etc.) to serve as a link between village/block and state level.

Block level : Activities under MSK was implemented at the Gram Panchayat level and facilitated through Block/Taluk level centres, which serve as the focal points and called MSK- Block Level



Photo courtesy: <https://www.voiceofmargin.com/mahila-shakti-kendras-online-programme-for-creating-awareness/>